

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

Pawn and Minor-Piece Endgames

Opposition, races, bishops, knights, fortresses, and zugzwang

TRAINING WORKBOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

Workbook Method

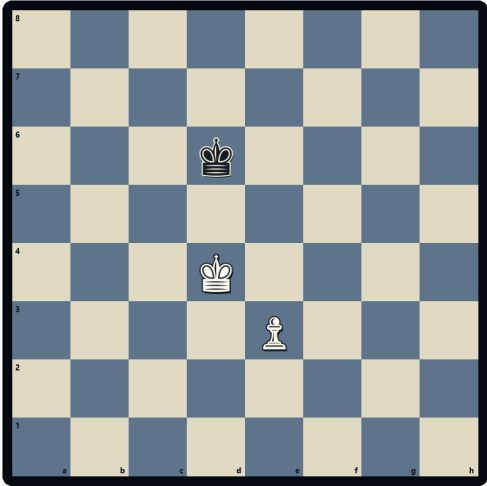
Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

01. Opposition



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Control the key entry square by forcing the enemy king to yield.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - opposition study

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

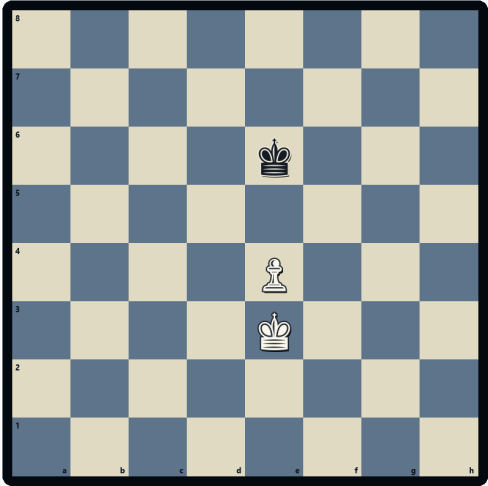
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

02. Distant Opposition



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Use the parity of squares to preserve the opposition from farther away.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - key-square study

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

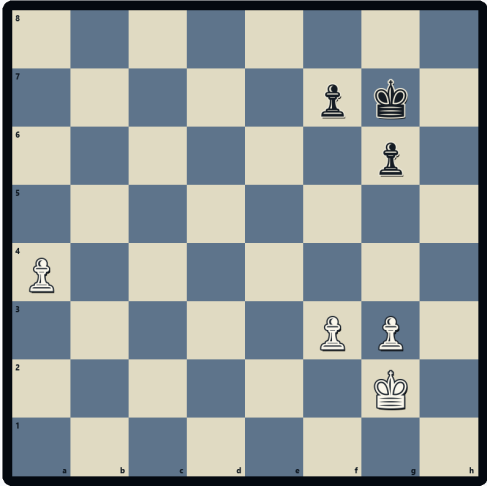
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- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

03. Corresponding Squares



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Some king positions are linked: entering one square forces the opponent into the matching square.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - create a diversion

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

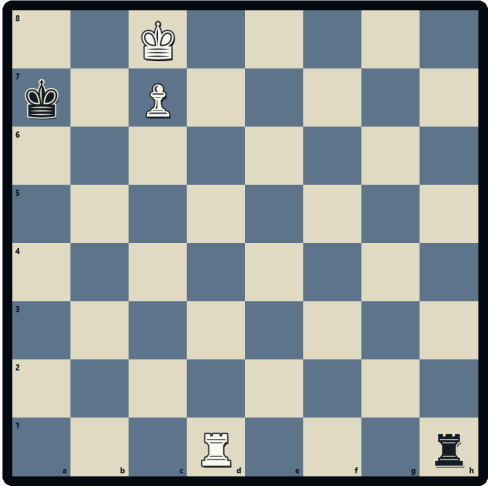
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

04. Key Squares



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

A pawn wins when its king reaches the correct key squares ahead of it.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - Lucena-type position

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

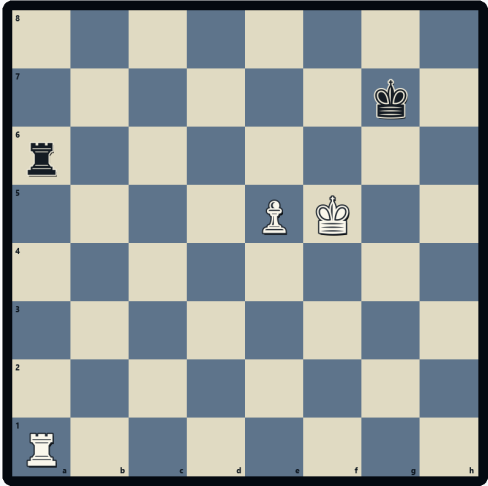
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FORECAST	__ / 2

05. Reserve Tempi



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

A spare pawn move can transfer the move and decide a king maneuver.

REFERENCE LINE

Black to move - Philidor-type defense

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

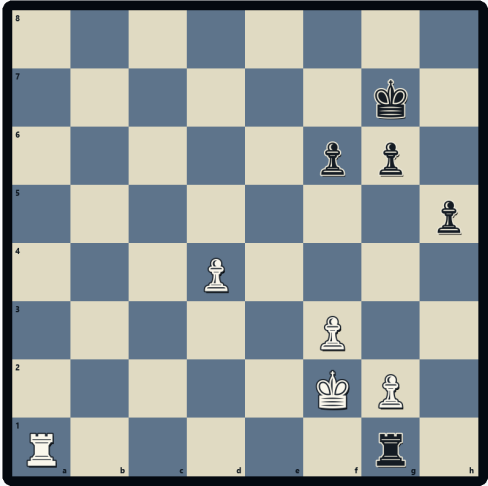
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

06. Outside Passed Pawn



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Create a distant passer to divert the king from the other wing.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - activity over passivity

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

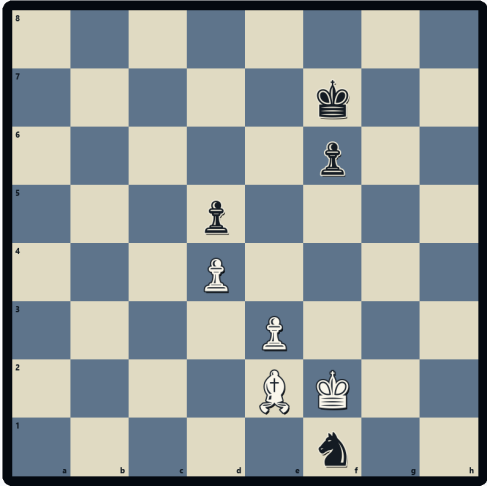
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FORECAST	__ / 2

07. Protected Passed Pawn



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

A protected passer restricts the king even when it cannot advance immediately.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - minor-piece evaluation

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

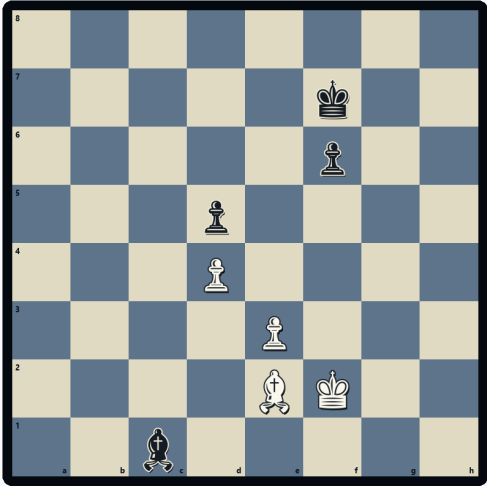
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

08. Pawn Breakthrough



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Sacrifice pawns to create a passer whose promotion tempo cannot be met.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - fortress and passer study

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

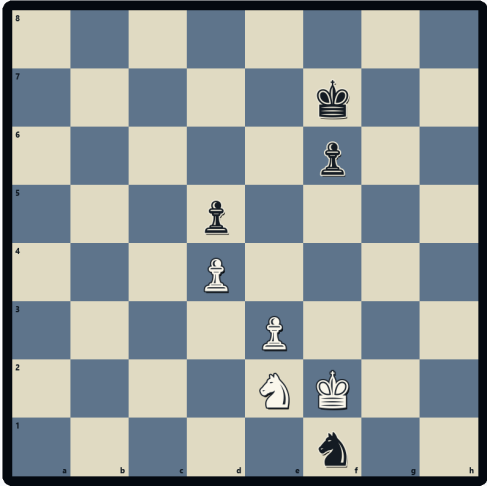
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

09. Pawn Race Calculation



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Count moves, checks, promotion with tempo, and whether the new queen controls the other promotion square.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - king and knight activity

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

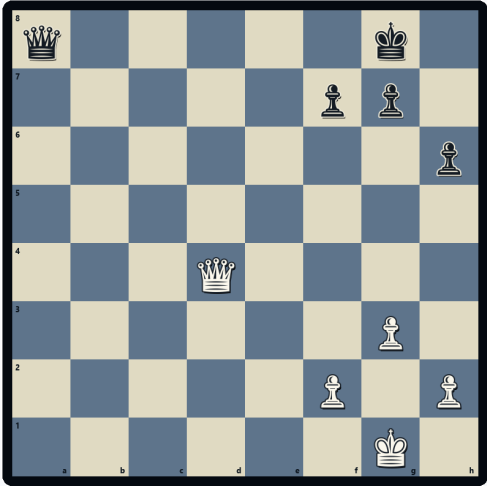
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

10. Bishop Versus Knight



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Judge the pieces by pawn placement, targets, and available outposts.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - checks and king shelter

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

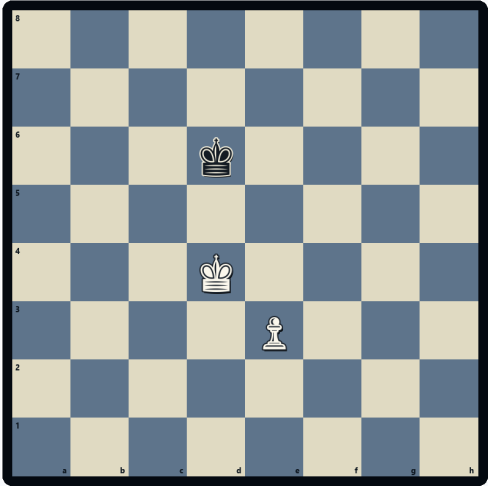
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FORECAST	__ / 2

11. Good and Bad Bishops



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

A bishop is bad when its own fixed pawns restrict its useful diagonals.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - opposition study

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

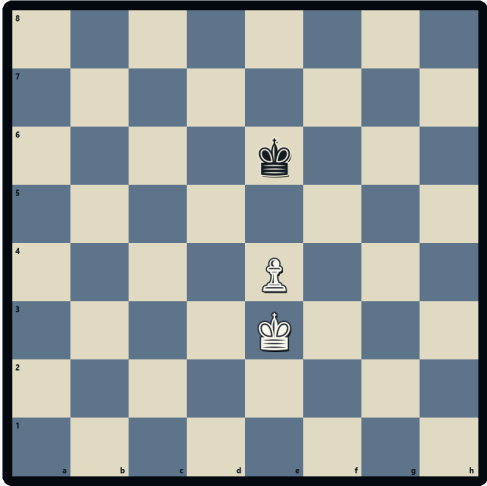
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

12. Opposite-Colored Bishops



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

The attacker uses a second weakness; the defender seeks a blockade and fortress.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - key-square study

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

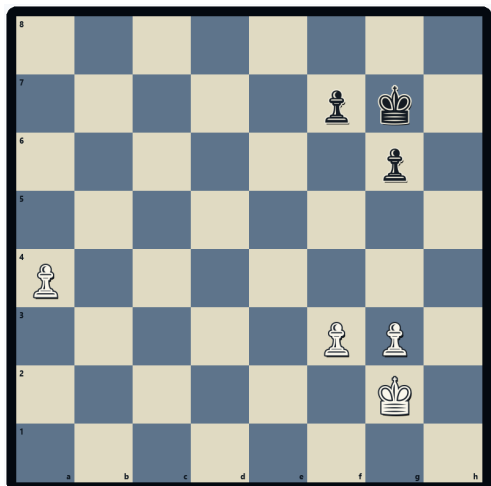
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THREAT	__ / 2
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

13. Same-Colored Bishops



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

King activity and penetration on the bishop's color often decide the ending.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - create a diversion

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- ### 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

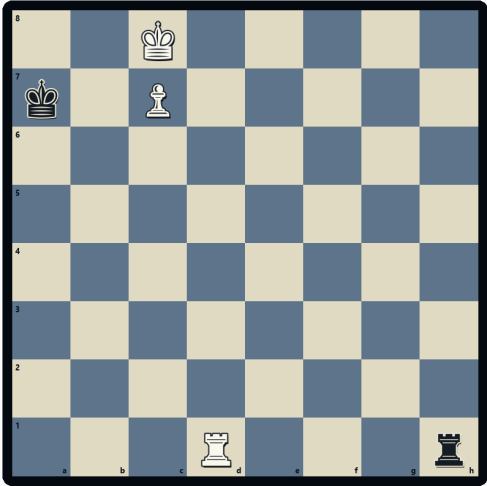
4. Which piece has the least useful job?

.....

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

14. Knight Outposts



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

A knight needs a stable square and reachable targets, not merely a protected post.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - Lucena-type position

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

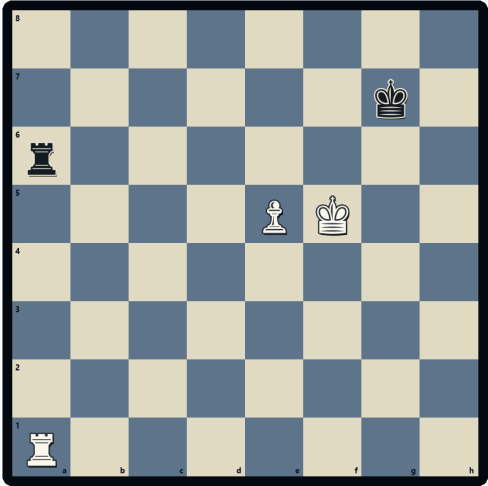
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

15. Knight Versus Pawns on Both Wings



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

The knight may struggle to switch wings; create play on both sides.

REFERENCE LINE

Black to move - Philidor-type defense

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

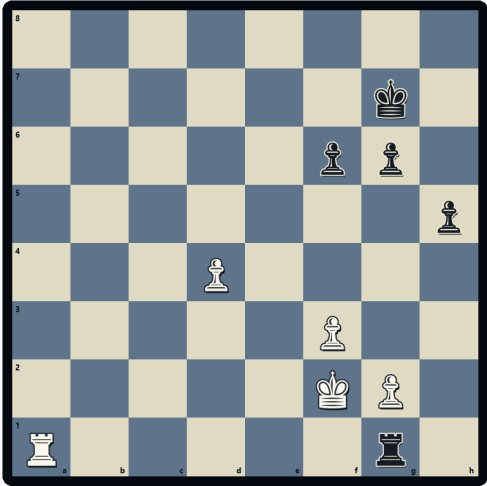
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

16. Bishop and Outside Passer



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Use the bishop's long range to support one wing while the king attacks the other.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - activity over passivity

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

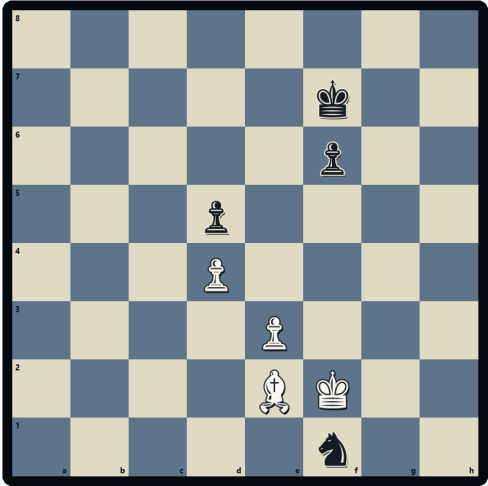
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

17. Minor-Piece Exchange



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Trade into a pawn ending only after calculating king access and reserve tempi.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - minor-piece evaluation

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

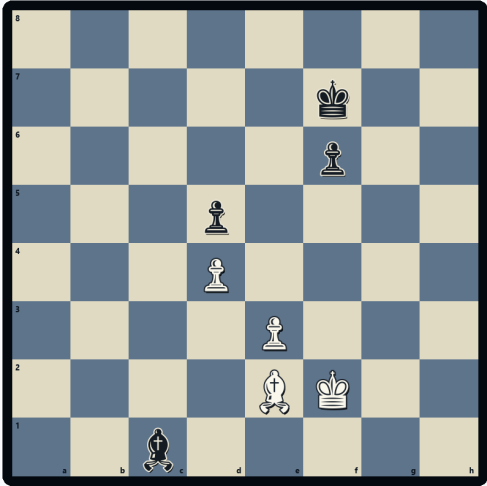
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CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

18. Fortress Recognition



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Stop pushing when every transformation destroys the only defensive setup.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - fortress and passer study

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

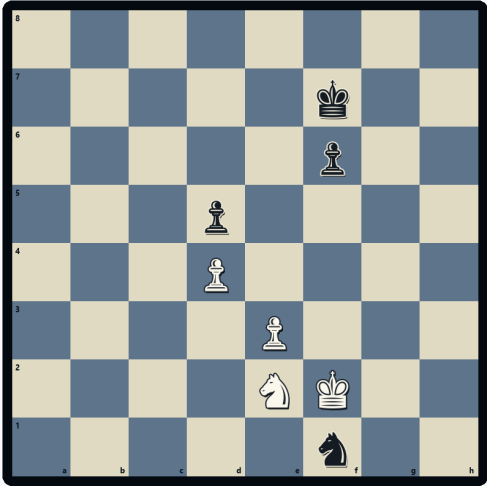
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

19. Zugzwang



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Improve the position until every legal move worsens the opponent's setup.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - king and knight activity

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

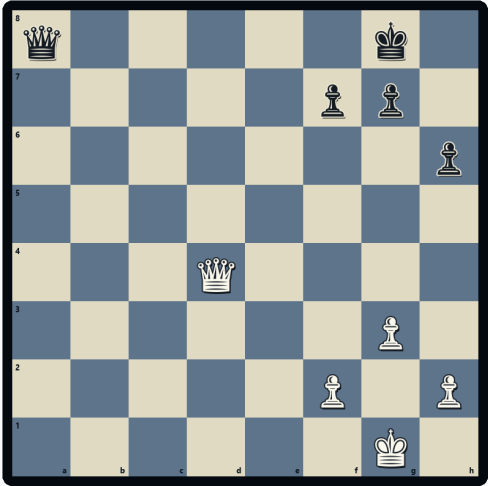
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

20. Endgame Calculation Routine



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

POSITION PROMPT

Map king routes, forcing captures, pawn races, and the final promotion square.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - checks and king shelter

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

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FORECAST	__ / 2

Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.